Table 4.2 Developments and pioneers of third-generation drone m

Drone model/year	Developer/country	Key features and capabilities	Primary role/applications	Techn signif
RQ-1 Predator (1995)	General Atomics Aeronautical Systems/United States	MALE UAV, SATCOM link, EO/IR sensor, laser targeting, armed with Hellfire missiles	ISR, precision strike, surveillance	First UAV comba introd real-ti targeti long- endura operat
RQ-4 Global Hawk (1998)	Northrop Grumman/United States	HALE platform, autonomous navigation, SAR radar, 36-hour endurance	Strategic reconnaissance, global intelligence missions	Revol long-r high-a ISR autonc flight multi- integra
MQ-9 Reaper (2007)	General Atomics Aeronautical Systems/United States	Heavy payload (3000+ lbs), multi-mission, advanced targeting pods,	Combat strike, persistent surveillance	Comb high-s capabi a large for simult survei and at